

Terms & Conditions of Service

Scope of Service

The Origin Hunter provides genealogical and family history research based on information supplied by the client, available historical records and the research sources reasonably accessible to the business.

Research may include:

- Family tree development
- Ancestral and family-line research
- Historical record searches, including civil registration, census and other relevant sources
- Investigation of specific questions, research challenges or “brick walls”

Client Responsibilities

The client agrees to:

- Provide accurate and truthful information
- Supply relevant known details that may assist the research
- Tell The Origin Hunter about material corrections or updates
- Avoid providing unnecessary sensitive or highly private information about living relatives
- Understand that the quality and direction of research depend on the information and evidence available

Limitations of Research

- Research depends on the availability, accuracy and accessibility of historical records
- Record coverage varies by country, region and time period; some projects may fall outside the sources The Origin Hunter can effectively research
- Some records may be incomplete, restricted, unavailable online or unavailable to The Origin Hunter
- Findings, family relationships, breakthroughs and specific outcomes cannot be guaranteed

Research Platform, Tree Access & Deliverables

- Research may be carried out using online genealogy platforms including Ancestry.com and Findmypast. Where a family tree is created or developed as part of the research, it will normally be built on Ancestry.com.
- Clients may be given guest access to view the family tree and the information added to it. Access to certain original records, images or documents may depend on the platform’s subscription requirements, and the client may need their own subscription to view some material directly.
- Unless otherwise agreed, the completed service will include access to the family tree together with a concise summary of the main findings, any significant uncertainties and suggested next steps where relevant. A detailed written research report is not included unless specifically agreed in advance.
- If requested, a GEDCOM copy of the tree may also be provided for use with other compatible genealogy platforms. Media, record images and some linked records may not transfer with a GEDCOM file.
- Trees created for the client will be kept private while under The Origin Hunter’s control, and available privacy settings will be used for living individuals.
- Working trees will be retained only for as long as reasonably necessary to complete the research and provide the agreed access. Where a GEDCOM file is requested, the working tree will normally be deleted once the client has confirmed successful receipt and import, or 14 days after the GEDCOM is provided if confirmation is not received.

Fees & Payment

- Fees and the chosen research package or agreed research option are confirmed before work begins
- Any additional paid research requires the client's approval in advance
- The Origin Hunter's own subscriptions to research services such as Ancestry or Findmypast are included in the agreed research fee where applicable; this does not provide the client with a personal subscription

Data Protection & Privacy

- The Origin Hunter will collect and process personal information only where reasonably necessary to provide family history research and administer the commission.
- Research may involve limited information about living individuals, such as names, dates or places of birth and family relationships. Such information will be handled with appropriate care and will not normally be made publicly accessible.
- Where family trees are created using genealogy platforms such as Ancestry.com, available privacy settings will be used for living individuals and the tree will remain private while under The Origin Hunter's control.
- Clients should avoid providing unnecessary sensitive or highly private information about living relatives.
- The Origin Hunter does not sell personal information. Full details of how information is collected, used, stored and protected, and of data protection rights, are set out in The Origin Hunter Privacy Notice available on the website.

Cancellations & Refunds

- For contracts agreed at a distance (for example online or by email), statutory cancellation rights may apply, including a 14-day cancellation period where required by law
- If the client expressly asks for research to begin during a statutory cancellation period and later cancels, the client may be required to pay a proportionate amount for work already carried out
- Nothing in these Terms & Conditions limits the client's statutory consumer rights

Intellectual Property

- The Origin Hunter retains ownership of its original research notes, report wording and presentation until agreed payment has been received
- After payment, the client may use the completed research, family tree and research summary or report for personal and family-history purposes.

Acceptance of Terms

- Acceptance is recorded through the Client Information Form. Before research begins, the client will be asked to confirm that they have read and agree to these Terms & Conditions and have read the Privacy Notice.